

The door to my freehold is always open. Let's tell more tales by the balefire together.

— Thaddeus "Gatharion" Papke (Columbus Ohio, USA)

Head Writer of the unofficial **Kithbook: Boggan**



That light flooding through stain glass was like water in the desert for me. Years of black and white sourcebooks of vampires looming in the shadows and those iconic images of Ron Spencer's Garou, and then here comes a goddamn dancing bear in a top hat in full color. I was in.

I had enjoyed previous World of Darkness games, but none lured me into the Storyteller seat until Changeling. It inspired me to run games, join the online fan community, build the website The Right To Dream, make my own shirts and costumes, and even adapt the world of Oz.

While I had enjoyed playing Vampire, Werewolf, Mage, and even Wraith, I felt like I truly belonged in Changeling. Gaming had always been about escapism for me, but in the other World of Darkness games, it felt like I was just escaping one bleak world into an even darker and bleaker one. The Dreaming could be grim, but it also held adventure, whimsy, creativity, and joy. The very act of playing staved off the banality of my own real world existence. It was like stepping into the Dreaming where anything was possible.

—Beau Brown



When I fell in love with the World of Darkness, it was the bleakness that pulled me in, first with Vampire and then Wraith. I was an angsty young adult with mental health problems, and the nihilistic gothic punk aesthetic spoke to me. For that reason, I underestimated Changeling for years and didn't get around to exploring it. It didn't really seem to fit with other

World of Darkness lines because it was too colorful (literally and otherwise), too filled with dancing bears and the power of imagination. Once I finally read the corebook, I realized my mistake. This was not a light game, but a paean to the sorrows of growing up and the challenges of holding onto childlike wonder in the face of the world's uglier truths. For all of its fantastic elements, Changeling presented a central horror that was almost shockingly real.

Even though I never had the privilege of writing for Changeling, it shaped me as an author. I became more fascinated by long-term consequences, both in unintended outcomes and examining how time grinds down even the greatest legends from the snapshot immortalized in their stories. I also realized how important it was to capture the "Oh Wow!" factor that Changeling's rich imagery and setting evoked. Many years later (and perhaps a Banality point or two higher), I'm still playing with these issues as a writer, game developer, and storyteller.

— Michael A. Goodwin



Changeling had me from the first scene we played, when a pooka hid in my troll childling's hair. It brought something completely different to our gaming table—childlike wonder slowly eroded away, mixed with a soupcon of unseelie naughtiness, topped off with epic tales of heroism and love gone wrong. When the world was ending—literally—I begged to be a part of it. Writing for Changeling was one of my favorite projects I've ever done, and completely worth cutting off my hair to cast that cantrip and befuddle the project team into hiring me.

— Carrie Harris, co-author of **Changeling** section in **World of Darkness: Time of Judgment**

*Illustrations by Liana Lavoie.*

